

Air Fryer Conversion Cheat Sheet

The complete conversion system: rules, tested food times, frozen adjustments and USDA safe temperatures. Print this and keep it near the kitchen. Always verify doneness with a food thermometer.

The conversion rules

Rule	Adjustment
Base rule	Oven temperature 25°F (15°C) · oven time × 0.75–0.8
Baked goods & desserts	Temperature 40°F · time × 0.8 (fan browns tops fast)
Frozen food	+35% time (5–15 extra minutes) · never thaw breaded or par-fried food
Large batch (about 2 lb)	+13% time — crowding blocks airflow
Family batch (3 lb and up)	+25% time, or cook in two batches
Oven-style / toaster-oven models	+10°F and +10% time vs. basket models
Reheating leftovers	3–4 minutes at 350°F, to 165°F internal
Empty basket caution	Never put empty parchment in a preheating air fryer — it can hit the element

USDA safe internal temperatures

Food	°F	°C	Notes
Chicken & turkey (all cuts, whole or ground)	165	74	No rest time required
Ground beef, pork, veal and lamb	160	71	Grinding spreads surface bacteria
Beef, pork, veal, lamb steaks / chops / roasts	145	63	Plus a 3-minute rest
Fish and shellfish	145	63	Or opaque and flakes easily
Fully cooked ham (to reheat)	165	74	140°F is enough for inspected ham
Egg dishes and casseroles	160	71	Yolk and white both firm
Leftovers (reheat)	165	74	Hot throughout, not just at the edges

Tested food times — fresh and frozen

Standard basket air fryer, about 1 lb portions, straight from frozen. Shake or flip at the halfway point unless noted.

Food	Fresh	Frozen
Chicken Wings	400°F (204°C) · 22 min	400°F (204°C) · 28 min
Chicken Breast	375°F (191°C) · 18 min	360°F (182°C) · 28 min
Chicken Thighs	380°F (193°C) · 25 min	360°F (182°C) · 33 min
Chicken Drumsticks	390°F (199°C) · 22 min	360°F (182°C) · 32 min
Frozen Chicken Nuggets	380°F (193°C) · 8 min	380°F (193°C) · 10 min
Chicken Tenders	380°F (193°C) · 12 min	390°F (199°C) · 14 min
Whole Roast Chicken	350°F (177°C) · 55 min	—
Turkey Breast	350°F (177°C) · 45 min	—
Bacon	350°F (177°C) · 9 min	350°F (177°C) · 12 min
Pork Chops	380°F (193°C) · 12 min	360°F (182°C) · 20 min
Pork Tenderloin	400°F (204°C) · 20 min	—
Steak	400°F (204°C) · 10 min	360°F (182°C) · 20 min
Hamburgers	375°F (191°C) · 12 min	375°F (191°C) · 16 min
Meatballs	380°F (193°C) · 11 min	380°F (193°C) · 14 min
Salmon Fillet	390°F (199°C) · 9 min	375°F (191°C) · 14 min
Shrimp	400°F (204°C) · 6 min	400°F (204°C) · 9 min
Breaded Fish Fillets	390°F (199°C) · 12 min	400°F (204°C) · 14 min
Frozen French Fries	400°F (204°C) · 15 min	400°F (204°C) · 16 min
Sweet Potato Fries	380°F (193°C) · 16 min	400°F (204°C) · 15 min
Tater Tots	400°F (204°C) · 14 min	400°F (204°C) · 14 min
Onion Rings	380°F (193°C) · 12 min	400°F (204°C) · 10 min
Mozzarella Sticks	380°F (193°C) · 8 min	390°F (199°C) · 7 min
Frozen Pizza	375°F (191°C) · 8 min	375°F (191°C) · 9 min
Brussels Sprouts	380°F (193°C) · 15 min	380°F (193°C) · 18 min
Broccoli	375°F (191°C) · 9 min	375°F (191°C) · 13 min

Tested food times — continued

Food	Fresh	Frozen
Baby Potatoes	390°F (199°C) · 20 min	400°F (204°C) · 22 min
Asparagus	390°F (199°C) · 7 min	390°F (199°C) · 11 min
Cauliflower	390°F (199°C) · 14 min	390°F (199°C) · 18 min
Zucchini	400°F (204°C) · 12 min	—
Green Beans	375°F (191°C) · 8 min	375°F (191°C) · 12 min
Corn on the Cob	390°F (199°C) · 12 min	390°F (199°C) · 16 min
Mushrooms	380°F (193°C) · 12 min	—
Carrots	380°F (193°C) · 16 min	380°F (193°C) · 20 min
Crispy Tofu	390°F (199°C) · 15 min	—
Falafel	375°F (191°C) · 14 min	375°F (191°C) · 12 min
Halloumi	380°F (193°C) · 8 min	—
Crispy Chickpeas	390°F (199°C) · 15 min	—
Cookies	320°F (160°C) · 8 min	320°F (160°C) · 11 min
Donuts	350°F (177°C) · 6 min	350°F (177°C) · 9 min
Reheating Leftover Pizza	350°F (177°C) · 4 min	350°F (177°C) · 6 min
Reheating Leftover Fries	400°F (204°C) · 3 min	400°F (204°C) · 6 min
Hard "Boiled" Eggs	270°F (132°C) · 15 min	—
Toast & Garlic Bread	370°F (188°C) · 4 min	370°F (188°C) · 6 min
Frozen Egg Rolls	390°F (199°C) · 10 min	390°F (199°C) · 12 min
Frozen Dumplings & Potstickers	380°F (193°C) · 10 min	380°F (193°C) · 12 min
Frozen Burritos	380°F (193°C) · 12 min	350°F (177°C) · 18 min
Apple Chips	300°F (149°C) · 25 min	—
Kale Chips	320°F (160°C) · 5 min	—
Frozen Fish Sticks	400°F (204°C) · 9 min	400°F (204°C) · 10 min
Jalapeño Poppers	370°F (188°C) · 12 min	375°F (191°C) · 9 min
Frozen Hash Browns	400°F (204°C) · 14 min	400°F (204°C) · 12 min

Frozen protein: chicken breast 360°F · 28 min · salmon 375°F · 14 min · shrimp 400°F · 9 min. All to the safe internal temperatures above.

Fix-it table

Problem	Fix
Soggy, not crispy	Single layer · preheat 3 minutes · shake at halfway
Burning on top	Lower the temperature 10–15°F · keep food clear of the element
Smoke during cooking	2 tbsp water in the drawer · clean the element weekly
Food sticking	Perforated parchment · oil the basket · never aerosol spray
Uneven browning	Shake more often · don't crowd · check the fan vent is clean
Breading falls off	Pat food dry first · use tongs, not a hard shake
Cold centre, dark outside	Drop 20–25°F · add time · verify with a thermometer
Cheese leaked out	Lower heat · shorter time · cook straight from frozen

Ten habits that fix most results

1. Cook in a single layer with a finger of space between pieces — two batches beat one full basket.
2. Preheat 3 minutes for anything under 25 minutes of cooking.
3. Pat protein dry before seasoning; frozen breaded food goes in straight from the freezer.
4. Use a pump oil mister, never aerosol spray — propellants damage the non-stick coating.
5. Shake or flip at the halfway point of every cook.
6. Sauce after cooking, or only in the final 2–3 minutes.
7. Use a thermometer: poultry 165°F, ground 160°F, whole cuts 145°F + 3 min rest, fish 145°F.
8. Perforated liners only — solid paper or foil blocks airflow.
9. Weigh down light food (kale, bread) with a rack so it cannot fly into the element.
10. Wipe the heating element weekly — grease there is the #1 cause of smoke and off-flavours.

Convert any oven recipe — including ranges, Celsius and UK gas marks — at airfryersmart.netlify.app. The food database (51 foods, full instructions) is at airfryersmart.netlify.app/foods.html. Timings are tested starting points; every machine differs slightly, so check food a few minutes early the first time. Temperature guidance follows USDA FSIS recommendations.